

After iPhone it's the Razer Blade

Someone has managed to whisk away two Razer Blade laptops from the company's R&D lab. Good news is the launch won't be delayed

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Secret Formula #1

The Indian F1 came and went, and we're all complain just a little less now when we're stuck in traffic. We are, afterall, part of an exclusive group now

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If you thought that Formula 1 is only about sitting in a car and driving around quickly for a few laps every weekend, then you'd be utterly wrong. Because like most things, there's a lot of background hard work that we need to appreciate, and don't normally see on television!

We take a look at just some of the key aspects of Formula 1, and the thinking, engineering and regulation that go behind it, shaping the sport as we see it today – a technological marvel.

Aerodynamics

A bit of fighter jet inspiration

While an F1 car is meant to stick to the road all the time, design elements are hugely inspired by a fighter jet. That inspiration is applied in reducing the effect of drag when following another car closely. The drag causes the F1 car to be slower and also lose some of the grip while cornering. However, that's where this inspiration ends, because the second biggest concern for the designers is keeping the car on the road, at speeds that reach beyond 320 kmph. While they aren't very visible, there are more than a dozen wings on the car – big and small, that create

downforce. The better the ability of the car to grip the road at speeds, the faster it can go. In the early 1970s, there was an experiment with higher rear wings and movable front wings. The resultant crashes we witnessed were nothing short of spectacular and extremely dangerous. Over time, regulations have been introduced that ensure that all F1 cars follow largely the same design, with safety being the primary concern.

The engine

Power, but not without reliability

Almost every component installed in an F1 car has a dual role to play –